
10 BTC

THE FIRST TRANSFER

007 / 12 JAN 2009 UTC / SATOSHI TO HAL FINNEY / LEGENDARY

I WAS THE RECIPIENT.

A tan mouse courier pilots a teal-and-cream mail plane above the curved Earth. A strapped crate marked 10 BTC rides behind him, and a golden route reaches towards California. The imagined delivery pictures Bitcoin's first known transfer from one person to another.

In January 2009, Hal Finney downloaded Satoshi Nakamoto's newly released Bitcoin software and began testing it. He later recalled that he may have been the first person besides Satoshi to run it. The two corresponded while Hal reported bugs and Satoshi fixed them. Their experiment included a transfer of 10 BTC from Satoshi to Hal. That transaction appears in block 170, whose recorded timestamp is 12 January 2009 at 03:30:25 UTC. The timestamp belongs to the block; it is not a record of the exact moment the two people pressed send and received it.

Hal's own account called it a test. The ten coins were not a purchase, a salary or a bet on their future price. This was a small but decisive step beyond a program that one person could run: another person could receive value through it. Years later Hal described himself, in a few plain words, as the recipient of the first bitcoin transaction.

The mouse, backpack and aircraft are fictional, not portraits or objects documented at the event. The coastal glow is an approximate California marker, not an exact landing point. The far origin remains off-frame: Satoshi's physical location is not established. A transaction did not travel by aircraft or follow this geographic route. The golden arc makes a digital handoff visible.

HIDDEN IN THE ART

01 TEN BITCOIN

The strapped crate marked 10 BTC recalls the test amount Hal described and the transaction recorded in block 170. It is a transfer amount, not a price tag or physical shipment.

02 THE MOUSE COURIER

The tan pilot wears goggles and a green backpack. He is a fictional messenger for the handoff, not a likeness of Hal Finney or Satoshi Nakamoto.

03 THE MAIL PLANE

The teal-and-cream propeller aircraft turns the test transfer into an imagined delivery. It carries the story, not a claim that bitcoin travelled by plane.

04 THE GOLDEN ROUTE

The arc enters from off-frame and meets a glow near California. It suggests a recipient without fixing an exact landing coordinate, locating Satoshi or mapping the network traffic.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Hal Finney, Bitcoin and Me, 19 March 2013; Bitcoin block 170 and the 10 BTC transaction; Giana Magnoli, 2009 interview with the Finney family. The courier, aircraft, crate and route are fictional symbols. The California marker is approximate; the sender's geographic location is unknown. Card phrase is a short excerpt from Hal's retrospective with capitalization normalized.